



YOU ARE **5 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**
240 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This is a view of the right side of an embryo with the fronds of the chorionic villi in the background. The curled shape of the embryo is clearly demonstrated. The umbilical cord attachment to the early placenta can just be seen.

“Are you feeling up one minute and down the next? Be reassured that this is a perfectly normal response to pregnancy hormones.”

It may not happen quite yet, but be forewarned that you may become very emotional or irrational during pregnancy and suffer from mood swings. You may cry at things that had previously not affected you. This is due to a combination of your rapidly fluctuating hormones and the fact that pregnancy is a major life change.

Mood swings can be difficult for both you and your partner—try to keep communicating with each other and explain how you are feeling, no matter how irrational it may seem.

MORE VEGGIES PLEASE!

Be creative to stimulate your appetite and get fiber, vitamins, and minerals:

- **Make an easy vegetable soup** with prepared vegetables.
- **Throw in a few vegetables** when you make a smoothie (see [Supernutritious smoothies](#))—cucumber, celery, peppers, and carrots are mild in flavor, but nutritious.
- **Grate zucchini and carrots** into soups, pasta sauces, and stews, or throw a handful of squash, frozen peas, broccoli, asparagus, or green beans into a risotto.
- **Experiment with vegetable pasta** such as butternut squash noodles. Use half pasta and half vegetable pasta.
- **Top a pizza** with vitamin C-rich peppers—they're crunchy, colorful, and nutritious.
- **Try sauerkraut and kimchi**—fermented vegetables are good for your gut bacteria.

TACKLING FATIGUE

You might find you have a sudden loss of energy as your body adapts, but after about week 13, you should start to feel more energized.

One cause of tiredness is anemia. If you had a restricted diet when you started pregnancy, your iron reserves may be low. Your doctor may recommend a blood test and advise taking supplements.